

## 1. Project Overview

Public Health Collaboration (PHC) seeks to update its website (<https://phcuk.org/>) to a modern, dynamic and clean digital platform that clearly communicates its purpose, credibility and ambitions. The redesigned website should better explain what PHC does, why it exists, and how it works to improve public health, as well as engaging a broad public audience and supporting PHC's strategic goals.

The current website contains valuable content but does not fully reflect PHC's authority, momentum or vision. A refreshed design should present PHC as confident, evidence-led and forward-thinking, while remaining accessible, trustworthy and inclusive.

## 2. Project Objectives

The redesigned website should:

- Clearly communicate PHC's vision, mission and core beliefs in a way that is immediately understandable to non-specialist audiences.
- Explain what PHC does in practical terms, including its advocacy, education, policy influence and community-building work.
- Strengthen PHC's public credibility by emphasising scientific rigour, professional expertise and collaboration.
- Encourage engagement from key audiences, including healthcare professionals, policymakers, educators, journalists and the general public.
- Support PHC's ambitions for growth, influence and impact through clearer pathways for involvement, membership and support.
- Integrate a new email marketing system using Twilio as well as embedding email magnets such as a metabolic health calculator.

## 3. Target Audiences

The website should balance clarity and authority for a mixed audience, including:

- Members of the public seeking trustworthy information on metabolic health and nutrition.
- Healthcare professionals interested in evidence-based practice and professional networks.
- Policymakers, educators and journalists seeking credible public health perspectives.
- Existing PHC members, supporters and partners.

Content and design should avoid jargon where possible, explain technical concepts clearly and signal credibility without appearing elitist or inaccessible.

## 4. Website Examples

We like the design of the following websites:

- The Food Foundation - <https://foodfoundation.org.uk/>
- Institute for Optimum Nutrition - <https://www.ion.ac.uk/>
- USDA's Dietary Guidelines - <https://realfood.gov/>

## 5. Design Principles

The new design should be guided by the following principles:

- **Modern and clean:** A contemporary visual language with ample white space, clear typography and restrained use of colour.
- **Dynamic but not noisy:** Subtle motion, modular layouts and visual hierarchy that guide the user without overwhelming them.
- **Human and credible:** Balance professionalism with warmth using imagery and tone that reflect real people and real-world impact.
- **Clear hierarchy:** Users should quickly understand who PHC is, what it does and why it matters within seconds of landing on the site.
- **Accessible:** Design should meet accessibility standards, including readable contrast, scalable text and intuitive navigation.

## 6. Content and Structure

The site structure should prioritise clarity and storytelling. Key sections should include:

- A strong homepage that succinctly communicates PHC's purpose, vision and current focus areas.
- Clear explanations of PHC's work streams, campaigns and initiatives.
- A dedicated section for evidence, research and position statements, presented in an approachable way.
- Opportunities for engagement, including membership, events, education programmes and partnerships.
- News, updates and thought leadership that demonstrate PHC's ongoing activity and relevance.

Content should be concise, purposeful and written in plain English with visual elements used to support understanding rather than decoration.

## 7. Functionality and User Experience

The redesigned website should:

- Be fully responsive and perform seamlessly across desktop, tablet and mobile devices.
- Feature intuitive navigation with minimal depth and clear signposting.
- Allow for easy content updates by PHC staff without technical complexity.
- Support future growth, including new programmes, campaigns and resources.

## 8. Success Criteria

The redesign will be considered successful if it:

- Improves user understanding of PHC's role and values.
- Increases engagement metrics such as time on site, page depth and conversions (e.g. sign-ups or enquiries).
- Receives positive feedback from stakeholders and target audiences.
- Provides a flexible, future-proof platform aligned with PHC's long-term ambitions.

## 9. Tone and Brand Alignment

The tone should be confident, evidence-led and constructive. The site should feel authoritative without being dogmatic and welcoming without being simplistic. Overall, the design should reflect PHC as a serious public health organisation that is unafraid to challenge consensus, grounded in science and focused on improving lives.

## **10. Student Learning Outcomes and Work Experience Value**

This micro-internship offers students a short but meaningful opportunity to contribute to a public health charity at a formative stage in its digital development.

Students will gain hands-on experience working on a live strategic brief, helping to shape how PHC communicates its purpose, credibility and ambitions to the public and key stakeholders. Their work will directly inform a genuine website redesign, rather than being a purely academic or hypothetical exercise.

The project provides insight into the charitable and public health sectors, including how evidence-led organisations operate, balance competing priorities and seek to influence public understanding and policy. Students will see how mission, governance and impact shape communication decisions in the third sector.

Participants will develop practical skills in communication and design thinking, including audience analysis, messaging hierarchy, clarity of language and visual storytelling. The work involves translating complex scientific and policy ideas into accessible, engaging content for non-specialist audiences.

Students will also gain experience of professional collaboration, working with PHC stakeholders, responding to feedback and refining ideas within real-world constraints and timelines.

Finally, the micro-internship offers a portfolio and CV-ready project with social impact, demonstrating how academic skills can be applied to real societal challenges. It is particularly valuable for students interested in careers in design, communications, public policy, public health or the charitable sector.